

1900 BCE

STONEHENGE COMPLETED

Built at the centre of circular earthworks dating back to about 3000 BCE, the stone monument now known as Stonehenge was completed some 1,000 years later. Huge standing stones topped with lintels were arranged in a ring around a horseshoe-shape of smaller stones, with an altar stone at the centre. Because the structure, and the avenue leading to it, are aligned with the sunrise at the summer solstice, it is believed to have had a religious or astronomical purpose.



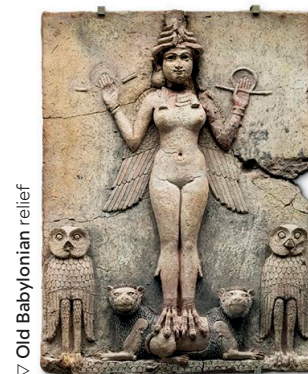
△ Stonehenge, stone circle

2000 BCE

c. 1900 BCE

THE AMORITE CONQUEST

The Amorites, a Semitic people from the Levant, traded in Akkadian Mesopotamia during the 21st century BCE. They came to occupy much of the southern part of the region, setting up independent city-states. One of these, Babylon, came to particular prominence as the capital of what was to become the First Babylonian Empire.



▽ Old Babylonian relief

c. 1900 BCE **The Hittites**
establish their empire
with its capital in
Hattusa, Anatolia

1772 BCE **King Hammurabi of Babylon** issues a law code that shifts emphasis from compensation of the victim to punishment of the offender

c. 1900 BCE

MINOAN PALACES

The Minoan civilization became established on the island of Crete in about 3000 BCE. It became a major trading power in the Mediterranean, and its prosperity is apparent in the impressive palaces – mainly administrative buildings – built from around 1900 BCE onwards in cities such as Knossos, Phaistos, and on the island of Thera (Santorini). These were often several storeys high, fitted with plumbing systems, and typically lavishly decorated.



△ Palace of Knossos, now partly restored and rebuilt